

Leave Policy

Guidelines for employee leave entitlements and procedures

Version:	v3.2	Effective Date:	January 1, 2024
Department:	Human Resources	Applies To:	All Employees

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy outlines the leave entitlements available to all full-time employees of Acme Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It defines the types of leave, eligibility criteria, application procedures, and conditions for approval. All employees are entitled to leave as described herein, subject to business requirements and manager approval.

2. Types of Leave

2.1 Casual Leave (CL)

Casual leave is intended for short-duration personal or family matters that require an employee's immediate attention.

Attribute	Details
Annual Entitlement	12 days per calendar year
Accrual	1 day per month, credited on the 1st of each month
Maximum per application	3 consecutive days
Carry forward	Not allowed — lapses on December 31st
Encashment	Not applicable
Notice required	Prior approval except in emergencies

2.2 Sick Leave (SL)

Sick leave is provided for employees who are unable to work due to illness or medical conditions.

Attribute	Details
Annual Entitlement	10 days per calendar year
Accrual	Credited in full at start of year
Medical certificate	Required for absences exceeding 2 consecutive days
Carry forward	Up to 5 days may be carried forward
Encashment	Not applicable

2.3 Earned Leave / Privilege Leave (EL/PL)

Earned leave is accrued based on days worked and can be planned in advance for vacations or personal needs.

Attribute	Details
Annual Entitlement	15 days per calendar year
Accrual	1.25 days per month worked
Minimum application	2 consecutive days
Notice required	Minimum 7 days in advance
Carry forward	Up to 30 days maximum accumulation
Encashment	Allowed at resignation or retirement

2.4 Maternity Leave

In accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act 1961 (amended 2017), female employees are entitled to maternity leave.

- 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children
- 12 weeks for the third child and beyond
- 8 weeks for adoptive mothers (child below 3 months)
- 6 weeks in case of miscarriage or medical termination
- Medical certificate confirming pregnancy and expected delivery date required
- Employee may combine maternity leave with other leave types subject to availability

2.5 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to paternity leave to support their partner and newborn.

Attribute	Details
Entitlement	5 paid working days
Eligibility	On birth or adoption of child
Timing	Must be taken within 3 months of birth/adoption
Application	Minimum 2 weeks advance notice recommended

2.6 Bereavement Leave

- Immediate family (spouse, child, parent, sibling): 5 days paid leave
- Extended family (grandparent, in-law): 3 days paid leave
- Additional unpaid leave may be granted at manager discretion

2.7 Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to all gazetted national holidays. A list of applicable holidays is published at the start of each calendar year by the HR department. Employees required to work on public holidays will receive compensatory off within 30 days.

3. Leave Application Procedure

- All leave requests must be submitted through the HR portal (hr.acme.com)
- Casual leave: apply at least 1 day in advance (except emergencies)
- Earned leave: apply at least 7 days in advance

- Sick leave: inform manager before 10:00 AM on the day of absence
- Managers must approve or reject leave within 2 business days
- Unapproved absence will be treated as Leave Without Pay (LWP)

4. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

When all eligible leave is exhausted, employees may apply for Leave Without Pay. LWP is subject to manager and HR approval and may affect benefits, increments, and performance ratings if excessive.

5. Contact

For questions about this policy, contact the HR department at hr@acme.com or extension 1001.